


Fig 21.2. *Left*: Michael Green (*left*) and John Schwarz hiking in Aspen, Colorado, in 1984, at the time of their breakthrough. *Right*: Michael Green (*left*) and John Schwarz (*right*) being awarded the three-million-dollar 2014 Fundamental Physics Prize for their breakthrough. In the middle are Yuri Milner (founder of the prize) and Mark Zuckerberg (Facebook cofounder).

Since the Green-Schwarz breakthrough, we physicists have taken superstring theory very seriously and have put great effort into exploring and extending it. And, consequently, we have taken very seriously the idea that the bulk truly exists and truly can influence our universe.

The Fifth Dimension

EG

Although superstring theory says the bulk has six more dimensions than our universe, there is reason to suspect that, for practical purposes, the number of extra dimensions is really only one. (I explain this in Chapter 23.)

For this reason, and because six extra dimensions is a bit much for a science-fiction movie, *Interstellar*'s bulk has just one extra dimension,